



ONE SHOT

REVISION SERIES

CLASS 10

HISTORY

PRINT CULTURE AND THE MODERN WORLD



Introduction



Importance of print in today's world 🤔



Was it always like this only? ➡

NO



Print do have its own history.



- What is this history?
- When did printed literature begin to circulate?
- How has it helped create the modern world?

The First Printed Books

China

System of handprinting. 🧐

[Rubbing the paper against the inked surface of woodblocks]

Limitation

- **Accordion book**
- Use of Books in China

- Huge Bureaucratic System → Civil Services Examinations
- Increasing urban culture. [New readership]
- Merchant use prints to record trade information.

Japan

- Buddhist missionaries introduced hand printing technology in Japan.
- Oldest Japanese book ***Diamond Sutra***. Printing on textiles, playing cards and paper money.
- Printing of visual material grew.

Ukiyo by Kitagawa Utamaro



Print Comes to Europe

How

Where in Europe 🧐

➤ Silk route → Paper
➤ Marco polo → Technology of woodblock printing → Reached Italy

Increasing reading public ↑ [Book fairs, scribes]



- The production could not satisfy the ever increasing demand for books.
- Limitations of Manuscripts. 🧐

Woodblock printing gradually became popular.

Gutenberg and the Printing Press

- In Germany, Johann Gutenberg developed first known printing press in 1430s.
- Son of merchant, saw wine and olive presses.
- Knew art of polishing stones, master goldsmith.

In 1448, **Invented printing press** working on this knowledge. 🧐

The new technology did not entirely displaced the existing art of producing books by hand. ➡ How

The Print Revolution and its Impact

How print created a revolution? 🤔

Earlier

Reading was restricted to the elites. Common people lived in a world of oral culture.

After Print Revolution

Before the age of print, books were not only expensive but they could not be produced in sufficient numbers. Now books could reach out to wider sections of people.

Hearing Public X Reading Public

[Sacred texts read out, ballads were recited that they reach out the wider section of people]

Oral culture thus entered print and printed material was orally transmitted. The line that separated the oral and reading cultures became blurred and the hearing public and reading public became intermingled.

Religious Debate and the Fear of Prints

Print ➡ Possibility of wide circulation of ideas. ➡ **Impact** 🤔



Even those who disagreed with established authorities could now print and circulate their ideas.

Apprehension

- Many thought that if there was no control over what was printed and read then rebellious and irreligious thoughts might spread.
- Authority of '**valuable**' literature would be destroyed.
- Criticism of new printed literature.

Revolution

- In 1517, Martin Luther wrote ninety-five theses.
- Criticise many of the practices and ritual of Roman Catholic Church.
- Led to beginning of the protestant reformation.
- "Printing is the ultimate gift of god and the, greatest one".

Print and Dissent 🤔

- Individual interpretation of faith.
- Menocchio, A miller in Italy.
- Reinterpreted the message of Bible.

When the Roman Church began its inquisition to repress heretical ideas, hauled up twice and ultimately executed.



Booksellers began to maintain an **Index of Prohibited Books from 1558.**

The Reading Mania

Setting up of schools by churches of different denominations.

- Literacy rate went up.
- Virtual reading mania was created.

New form of popular literature appeared in print 🧐

- Almanacs, ballads and folk tales were published.
- Penny chapbooks were carried by chapman in England. In France 'Bibliothèque Bleue' were sold.
- Periodical press were developed which produced the information of current affairs with entertainments, wars and trade. [Newspaper and journals]
- The ideas of scientists and philosopher now became more accessible to common people. [Discovery of Isaac Newton began to publish]
- The writing of thinkers such as Thomas Paine, Voltaire and Jean Jacques Rousseau widely printed and read.

Tremble, Therefore, Tyrants of the World

Tremble ➡ Involuntary shaking or movement

Tyrants ➡ Cruel and oppressive ruler.

Books ➡ Means of spreading progress and enlightenment, could change the world and liberate society from despotism and tyranny.

Louis-Sebastien Mercier ➡ 'The printing press is the most powerful engine of progress, and public opinion is the force that will sweep despotism away'. 🧐

Print Culture and the French Revolution

Print culture created the conditions within which French Revolution occurred.

1. Prints popularised the ideas of Enlightened thinkers.

Their ideas argued to judge everything through the application of reason and rationality.
[Writing of Voltaire and Rousseau were read widely]

2. Print created a new culture of dialogues and debates.

Values, norms and institutions were re-evaluated and discussed by a public. The need to question existing ideas and beliefs came into public sphere.

3. Outpouring of literature mocked the royalty and criticised their morality.

Cartoons and caricatures showing the pleasure of monarchy and sufferings and hardship of common people.

We must remember that people did not read just one kind of literature.



Print did not directly shape their minds, but it did open up the possibility of thinking differently.

The Nineteenth Century

Children



- Children press in France, 1857.
- Grimm brothers in Germany spent years compiling traditional folktales gathered from peasants.
- Censorship.

Women



- Women became an important readers as well as writers.
- Penny magazines teaching proper behaviour and housekeeping.
- Novelist like **Jane Austen**, the **Bronte Sisters** and **George Eliot**.
- Women: A person with will, strength of personality, determination, and power to think.

Workers



- Lending libraries.
- Self educated working class people wrote for themselves.
- Time for self-improvement and self-expression.
- Wrote political tracts and autobiographies.

Further Innovation

There were a series of innovation in printing technologies.

- Power-driven cylindrical press by **Richard M. Hoe**.
- **Offset press** was developed which could print up to six colours at a time.
- **Electrically operated presses** accelerated printing operation.
- Methods of feeding paper were improved, paper quality became better, automatic paper and photoelectric controls of the colour register were introduced.
- Periodical **serialised** important novels.
- Dust cover or the jacket were invented.
- Changes during great depression ➡ **Cheap paperback edition**.

India and the World of Prints

Manuscripts were used before the age of print. ➡ **Limitation** 🤔

Print came to India ➡ **Goa** ➡ **Tamil** ➡ **Malayalam** ➡ **English**

James Augustus Hickey ➡ **Bengal Gazette** [A commercial paper open to all, but none]



Controversy with British East India Company [Governor General Warren Hasting]

Indians who published Indian Newspaper. ➡ Bengal Gazette by **Gangadhar Bhattacharya**

Religious Reforms and Public Debates ➡ **Print** ➡ Reforms and counter reforms. 🤔

Reformers **VS** **Hindu Orthodoxy**

- Over issues like widow, immolation, monotheism, Brahmanical priesthood and idolatry.
- **Sambad Kaumudi** ➡ Rammohan Roy
- **Samachar Chandrika** ➡ Hindu orthodoxy
- From 1822, two persian newspaper **Jam-I-Jahan Nama** and **Shamsul Akbar**.
- A Gujarati newspaper ➡ **Bombay Samachar** appeared in the same year.

Impact of print among Hindu and Muslims. 🤔

New Form of Publication 🤔

Novels

- Europe to India [Acquired distinctively Indian form].
- People could now read what they wanted to see in their own lives experiences, emotions, and relationship.

New Literary forms

- Other new literacy material also entered the world of reading — lyrics, short stories, essays about social and political matters.

Painting

- Publishing of visual material.
- Raja Ravi Varma.
- Diversified use of paintings.
- Shaped ideas about modernity and traditions, religion and politics and society and culture.

Caricatures and Cartoons

- Commenting on social and political issues.

Women and Print

Women Education 🧐

Liberal husbands and fathers

- Began educating their women folk at home.
- At times they were sent to school.

Conservatives and Orthodox families

- Hindu conservatives believes that a literate girl would be widowed.
- Muslims feared that educated women would be corrupted.

Rebel women defied such prohibition.

- **Rashsundari Debi** → **Amar Jiban** [1876] → Full length autobiography in Bengali language.
- **Kailashbashini Debi** and her experiences.
- **Tarabai shinde** and **Pandita ramabai** wrote with passion about the miserable live caste Hindu women.

Vernacular press were devoted
for education of women.



They discussed issue like women's education, widowhood,
widow remarriage and the national movement.

Ram Chaddha ➡ Istri Dharam Vichar

The khalsa tract society published cheap booklets with message to teach women how to be obedient wives.

The Battala ➡ Known for publishing cheap editions of religious tracts and script, as well as literature that was considered obscene and scandalous. ➡ Pedlars took the Battala publication to homes.

Print and the Poor People 🧐

- Very cheap small books were sold at crossroads.
- Public libraries → Expanding to access to books. ➡ For rich local patrons, setting up a library was a way of acquiring prestige.

Issues of caste discrimination began to be written.

- Jyotiba Phule → Gulamigiri [1871]
- B.R. Ambedkar, E.V. Ramaswamy Naicker also wrote on these issues.

Involvement of people from working class in writing.

- **Kashibaba [Mill workers from Kanpur]** → Published chote or bade ka Sawal
- Poems of Kanpur mill worker under the name **sudarshan chakra**

Print and Censorship

Earlier, censorship was restricted to Englishmen in India. 🧐 ➡

Why

- By 1820's **Calcutta supreme court** passed certain regulation to control press freedom.
- In 1835, Governor-General Bentinck revised press law on request of editors of English and Vernacular newspaper.

But after the revolt of 1857, censorship became strict. ➡ **Why**

- 'Native' press were clampdown.
- **Vernacular press act**, 1878 was passed.

Despite all this, Nationalist print grew in numbers. ➡ Kesari → Bal Gangadhar Tilak.



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